

things and negative things. And we have to [as] society be more oriented towards the positive side and be more careful about preventing the negative side... that's an area that is evolving, and the regulations and societal norms are very important.

My biggest concern is that in the world of AI, to talk about AI and digital technologies, the world is getting split in two halves—the American half and the Chinese half. And the two halves don't talk and their ability to talk is decreasing year by year. And so do we have any hope for a global system? The chances of that are decreasing.

I don't want to appear pessimistic, but if the two major powerhouses in the world of technology don't want to talk to each other, don't want to agree to common norms and principles and regulations, it's a cause of concern.

54 | Q: And they could have very different views on personal IP. My concern is how do we protect ourselves because anyone could easily make an AI avatar of you and say whatever it wanted to, and if you complain, they say, 'Oh, well, he has blue eyes and you don't.' Where do you draw the line?

A: That's a very important and hard question, with no easy answers. Today, you're already seeing challenges in the case where you can use generative AI to learn from an artist's style of paintings and create a similar style of painting. And the question is, is that fair use of IP? Today, the challenge is that, again, we don't have rules and regulations that govern this very well. It's all very fluid and very different across geographies. And also, what we have is that, in some sense, the technology will evolve to a point at which it'll on the one hand make it very easy to manipulate these things. On the other hand, hopefully, it will give us tools to control it also better from our individual point of view. By which I mean, today, largely, we are in a Web 2.0 world. And the Web 3.0 world is being created; the technology stack for the Web 3.0 world is not yet complete... And the hope is that when the technology stack for Web 3.0 is done and rolled out and more widely available, individual citizens like you and I will have more control over our own data.

So till we don't have that Web 3.0 [stack] commercially widely available—and it could be 5-10 years



from now—in the meantime, we are at the mercy of the tech companies, and to some degree government regulations around them. And that's one reason why you're finding the tech companies collecting as much data as possible. Often the data being collected is not directly being used right now, but they are collecting it in the hope that maybe sometime in the future, they'll find ways to use it... the tech companies who are the leaders in the space have to adopt their own internal standards, internal ethics, in guiding some of their own actions. Some of it is happening, and I hope [will] become stronger, but a lot more needs to be done in this area.

Q: Another side of life that affects all of us is love. Do you think with the amount of data we have, will we algorithmically be able to find our soul mate?

A: You're asking me all the tough questions. I hope it'll allow us to find love not just in terms of the person we choose to love, but also in terms of things we love to do. Because I really think that AI will allow us more possibilities, will give us more skills—I might be a terrible musician, but with some AI maybe I can compose better music. So what I'm saying is that it'll help us to do more of the kind of activities we love, and maybe love and find the right people also. But hopefully, that is a positive note to end on. It'll help us to become more loving and more loved and hopefully become better individuals and better human beings. **BT**

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